

Aaron "Smiley" Cate

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Introduction

I am a live music lover with 1000s of shows under my belt, turned live visual artist, turned self-taught audiovisual technician with years of hands-on experience in live event production. My expertise comes from working directly in the field, setting up and operating AV systems at festivals, raves, and concerts. I have honed my skills through real-world applications rather than traditional certifications, making me highly adaptable and efficient in fast-paced environments.

Credentials & Qualifications

- Years of hands-on experience in AV setup, live visuals, and event production
- Deep knowledge of 2D and 3D digital visuals, projection mapping, and LED wall operation
- Strong background in live visual mixing and VJing for music events
- Proficient with industry-standard AV software and hardware
- Experienced in troubleshooting and problem-solving under live event conditions
- Extensive collaboration with artists, musicians, and event organizers

Work Experience

Freelance AV Technician / Visual Artist / Stagehand (2018 - Present)

- Designed and executed live visuals for concerts, festivals, and raves
- Set up and operated LED walls, projectors, and other display technologies
- Managed audio-visual components for multi-stage events
- Coordinated with event organizers and technical teams to ensure seamless execution
- Worked hundreds of shows in various roles, from pushing cases to doing security to running visuals

Smilebot Productions (2012 - Present)

- Designed logos, merchandise, websites, brands, and visuals for clients across industries
- Video production for events, music videos, parties, and businesses, including smart installs, LED panels, TVs, lighting, audio, and projectors
- 3D/VR design and implementation for virtual experiences and events
- Live streamcast producer/technician for large virtual events and concerts

Notable Events & Projects

- Country Music Awards - Prop Dept, I.A.T.S.E - Assisted in stage setup, prop management, and breakdown
- Imagine Music Festival - Video Production Lead (V1) - Managed video production, content execution, and team leadership
- Believe Music Hall - Visual Director & Video Lead/VJ - Oversaw full video production, upgrades, and crew coordination

Skills & Technical Proficiency

- Software: Resolume, TouchDesigner, MadMapper, Adobe Suite
- Hardware: LED walls, projectors, media servers, lighting control systems
- Live Production: VJing, video mixing, projection mapping, stage setup, stagehand
- Troubleshooting: Equipment maintenance, system optimization
- Collaboration: DJs, musicians, festival teams, stage crews

References

- Joey Appleseed (Iris Presents / Imagine Music Festival) - 770.912.6752
- Aireon "Ployd" Grimes (Slow&Low; Presents) - 678.480.5784
- Kevin Rodriguez (Aisle5, Georgia Event Specialists) - 470.725.8323